NEW MASONS EVENING · CARD 2 OF 3

The Festive Board

Etiquette

- Light-hearted and fun, but the Lodge's rules still apply: no religion, no politics.
- Jackets on, unless the Master says otherwise in summer.
- Phones away. A quick photo of dinner, fine; a running text conversation, not. Need a call? Leave the room.
- Stand when the Director of Ceremonies stands; follow the Brother next to you.

Replying to a toast, in six lines

1	Start with "Worshipful Master, Distinguished Brethren, Brethren all".
2	Thank the Lodge for the meeting, the work, and the Brother who invited or looked after you.
3	Mention one thing you enjoyed. One good piece of ritual is plenty.
4	Invite them to your next meeting.
5	One to two minutes. Do not rush, and do not give a best man's speech.
6	You may move to where people can see you, but no laps of the room.

Do I have to attend?

You should, and you will enjoy it more if you do. If you cannot, send apologies to the Secretary. Nobody will pressure you; if anything is making it hard, tell your mentor or the Almoner.

> **Taylor's or Emulation?** The two main workings in Hertfordshire. Emulation is the more relaxed; Taylor's has more floorwork. Learned one and asked to work in the other? Ask first.

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Visiting, and the questions you asked

Can I visit other Lodges?

Yes, and it is encouraged. Contact the Lodge Secretary, introduce yourself, and expect to reply to the Visitors' Toast. Go with your mentor the first time. Lodges work differently; observe before judging, and never criticise another Lodge's working.

What do I tell people at work?	The truth: you have joined a Lodge, you meet a few times a year, there is a dinner, and it raises a lot for charity.
Can I post about it online?	Yes, with judgement. The Festive Board and charity events, fine; anything from inside the Lodge room, not.
Can my partner get involved?	Yes. White Table evenings invite partners to dine; Ladies Night is the Master's formal dinner each year.
When will I take office?	When you are ready and if you want to. Nobody should push you early, and nobody should leave you waiting. Talk to your mentor.
What is the Royal Arch?	The completion of Pure Antient Masonry. Your Lodge's Royal Arch Representative will explain it when you are ready. Information, not recruitment.
Can I attend Provincial Grand Lodge?	Once you are a Master Mason.

If you are struggling, say so, early, to anyone: your mentor, the Almoner, the Club. Money, time, family, confidence. The question is always "How can we help?", never "Why haven't you been attending?".

Three things to do this week

- Join the Fleet House Light Blues Club: fhlbc.co.uk/join-us.
- Sign up to Solomon: solomon.ugle.org.uk. Start with Welcome Apprentice.
- Message your mentor with one thing from tonight you want to talk about.